2026 Report on Tokenization Adoption

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CTM
COALITION FOR TOKENIZED MARKETS

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National survey shows path to broader support for tokenized assets through practical benefits, trust, regulation, and familiar financial channels

Methodology: *HarrisX online poll of 2,008 U.S. registered voters, fielded May 1–4, 2026. Results were weighted to align with national proportions for registered voters across key demographic and political variables. Margin of error ±2.2 points at the 95% confidence level. Subgroup results carry larger margins of error.*

Introduction

Tokenization, the process of creating digital representations of real-world assets, has the potential to make traditional financial products faster to trade, easier to transfer, and more accessible across platforms and account types. It is emerging as one of the most consequential applications of digital-asset technology for banks, asset managers, brokerages, retirement platforms, and everyday investors.

In continuing its legacy of premier public opinion polling, HarrisX conducted a national survey of 2,008 U.S. registered voters to measure perceptions of digital assets and tokenized investments. Several key findings emerged from the survey:

- **Americans are cautious and underinformed about digital assets, but they are open to tokenization when it is framed as practical financial modernization rather than crypto innovation.** Only 31% are familiar with tokenization, yet interest rises when Americans see concrete benefits and access through familiar, established financial channels.
- **The strongest perceived consumer benefits are practical:** faster settlement, 24/7 access, easier transfers, fractional ownership, and broader access to investments. By contrast, blockchain itself is not a compelling consumer message. Americans respond less to the technology and more to what it enables.
- **Adoption will depend on confidence.** Consumers want tokenized investments to feel protected, regulated, affordable, and easy to hold in accounts they already use. The open-ended responses reinforce this: many Americans are confused, and skeptics worry about hacking, scams, volatility, lack of regulation, and whether digital assets are truly backed.
- **This gives major financial institutions a clear advantage.** Banks, asset managers, brokerages, and retirement platforms can make tokenization feel more familiar, credible, and safe. The opportunity is to define tokenization before it is defined as another speculative crypto product.

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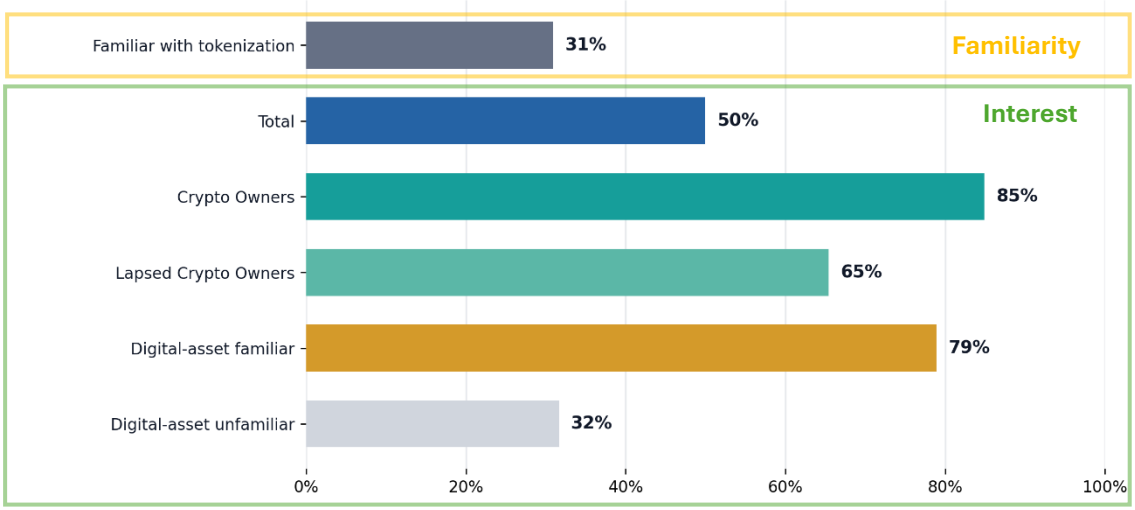
Finding 1: Tokenization has an awareness problem, not necessarily a demand problem

Americans are still learning about digital assets, and their views are not yet firmly settled. Only 39% say they are familiar with digital assets and blockchain technology, while 61% say they are not familiar. Views of cryptocurrencies are also evenly split: 34% have a favorable view, 34% have an unfavorable view, and 33% are neutral.

At the same time, digital assets already have meaningful consumer reach. 22% of Americans currently own cryptocurrencies, while 40% of Americans have purchased cryptocurrency at some point, and about 27% have purchased stablecoins.

Tokenization starts with lower awareness, with only 31% familiar before the survey definition. But once Americans are shown concrete benefits, they see practical value.

% Interested in tokenized versions of standard investments



TK1. "Tokenization" refers to using blockchain technology to create digital versions of traditional investments - like stocks, bonds, money market funds, or real estate - so they can be bought, sold, and transferred online 24 hours a day. Before today, how familiar were you with tokenization or tokenized investments?
TK4. If your bank, brokerage, or retirement account offered tokenized versions of standard investments - for example, a tokenized money market fund or a tokenized version of a stock you already own - how interested would you be in using them?

Interest in tokenized investments after exposure to potential benefits:

Early Adopters. Interest in tokenized investments is strongest among consumers already closest to the category: Current crypto owners show the highest interest (85%), followed by those familiar with digital assets (79%) and lapsed crypto owners (65%), indicating early adoption is likely to come from those already exposed to digital assets.

Age. Interest is 64% among 18–34-year-olds and 67% among 35–49-year-olds, compared with 43% among 50–64-year-olds and just 24% among those 65+. This shows

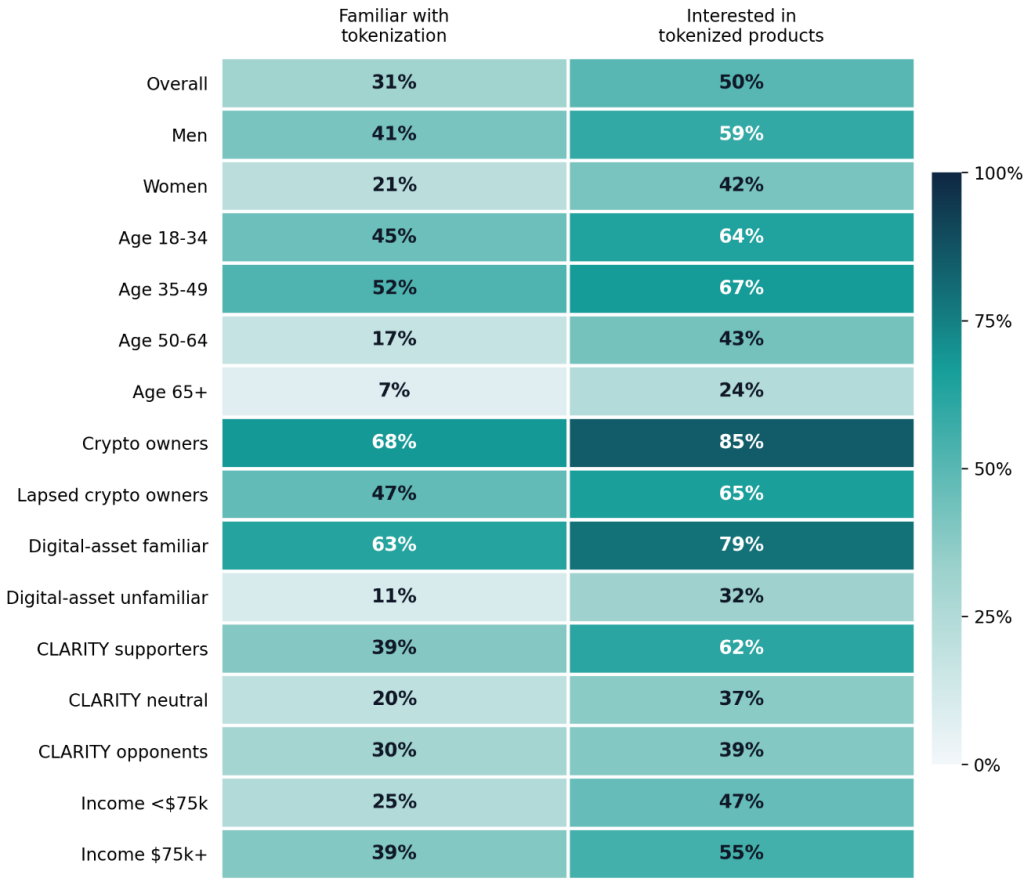
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a clear generational divide: younger and middle-aged Americans are much more open to tokenized investments, while interest drops sharply among older Americans.

Gender. Interest is higher among men than women, 59% vs. 42%, pointing to men as a more reachable early audience while the meaningful level of interest among women shows that tokenization still has broader consumer reach.

Income. Interest is 55% among those with an annual household income of $75k+ and 47% among those below $75k. This suggests higher-income adults may be somewhat more ready for early tokenized products, but the relatively strong interest among lower- and middle-income adults shows the category is not limited to a high-income niche.

Where tokenization over-indexes



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Once the benefits are explained, tokenized investments generate meaningful interest across the nation, not just among a narrow crypto audience. Interest is strongest among consumers already closest to the category, younger or middle-aged, male, and higher-income adults. But the data also show broader potential: sizable shares of lower- and middle-income adults, women, and those outside the most digitally familiar segments express interest as well.

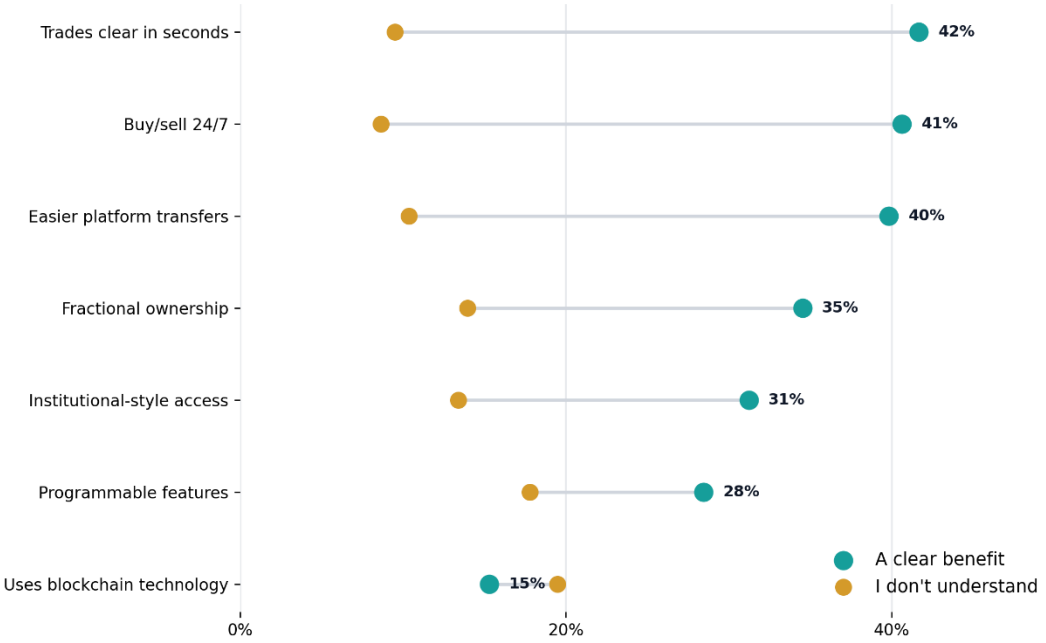
Finding 2: Interested consumers want utility, not technical novelty

Respondents were shown a list of possible features of tokenization and asked whether they viewed each as a benefit, drawback, both, neither, or if they did not understand.

The results demonstrated that consumers are most likely to recognize practical, easy-to-understand features as benefits: trades clear in seconds, 24/7 buying and selling, easier movement between platforms, and fractional ownership all rise to the top.

By contrast, more technical concepts are less compelling. “Uses blockchain technology” is the weakest-tested claim, with only 15% seeing it as a clear benefit and a 19% saying they do not understand it.

The consumer case is utility, not blockchain itself



TK3. Below are some claims people make about tokenized investments. For each, please tell us whether you personally see this as a benefit, a drawback, both, or neither.

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Respondents who were interested in tokenized investments were later asked which features would matter most to them. The top responses reinforced the findings:

Most Important Features of Tokenized Investment *Among those interested (50%)*	**%**
Lower fees and costs	42%
Ability to buy and sell 24 hours a day, 7 days a week	40%
Faster settlement (your trade clears in seconds, not days)	37%
Ability to own a fractional share of expensive assets	34%
Easier transfer of investments between platforms	31%
Direct access to investments usually reserved for institutions	27%
Programmable features (e.g., automatic dividends, automated rebalancing)	19%

TK5. You said you would be at least somewhat interested in tokenized investments. Which of the following features would matter MOST to you?

Taken together, the data supports that the most compelling consumer case for tokenization is that it can make familiar financial products faster, more flexible, easier to access, and potentially available to more investors, while the technical aspects (blockchain, programmable features) are less.

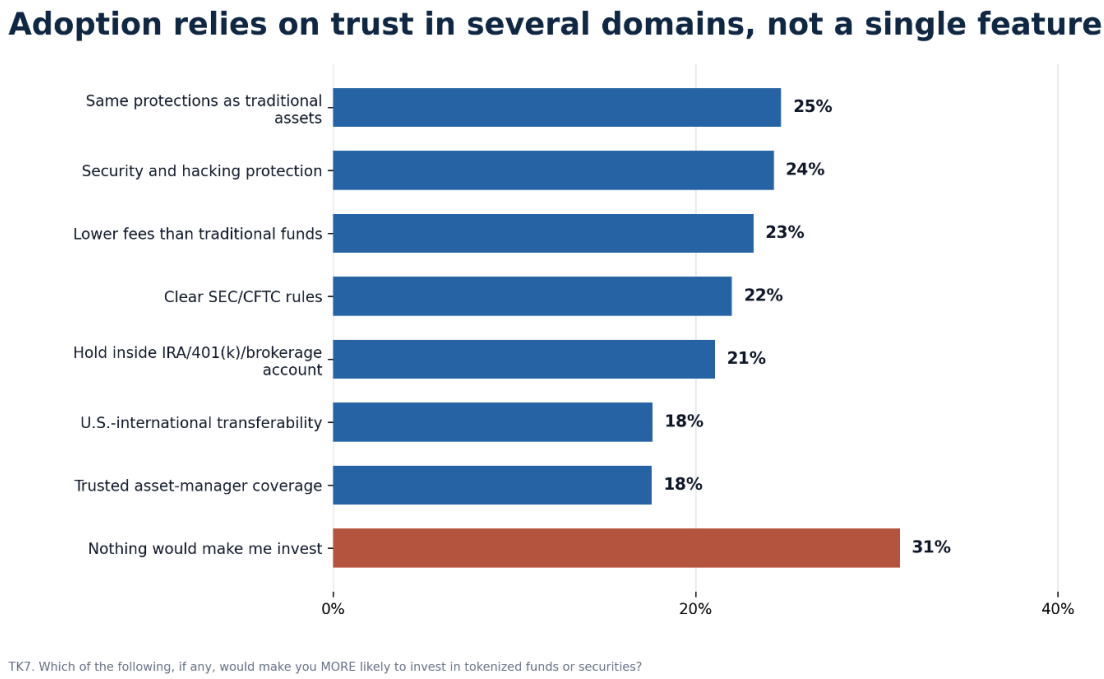
The strongest lesson is that Americans respond better to tokenization as a modernization of financial infrastructure than as a crypto concept.

Finding 3: Adoption depends on confidence, not just product features

Americans are more likely to consider tokenized investments when they feel protected, regulated, affordable, and easy to use. No one feature or protection stands out as enough on its own to make Americans more likely to invest.

Instead, Americans point to a broader mix of requirements: traditional investor protections, security against hacking, lower fees, clear SEC/CFTC rules, and the ability to hold tokenized products inside accounts they already use.

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TK7. Which of the following, if any, would make you MORE likely to invest in tokenized funds or securities?

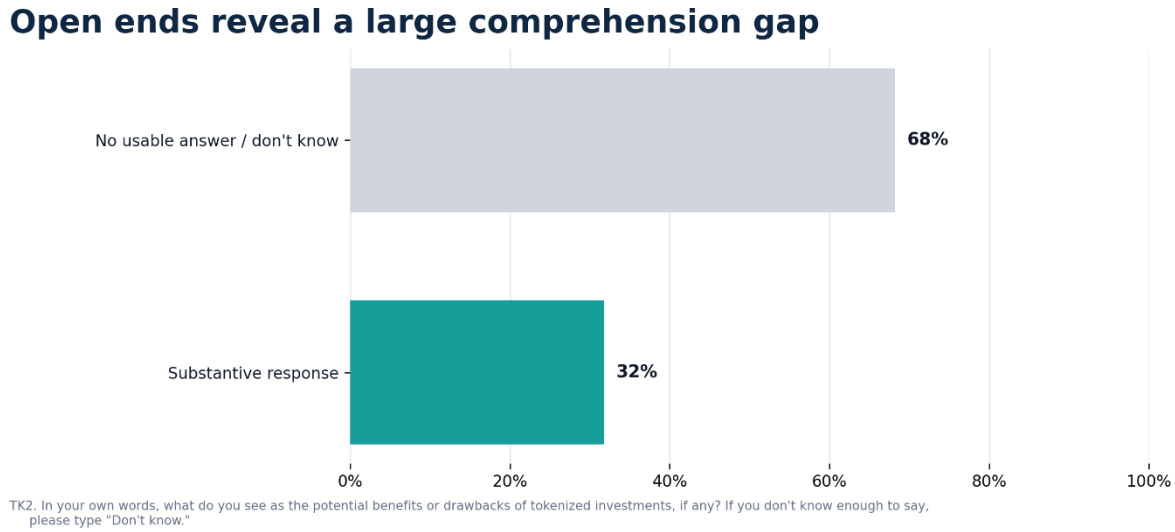
The data also shows that cross-border coordination matters to Americans: after being told that U.S. and European regulators are developing separate rules that could make it harder for tokenized funds to be sold or transferred across regions, 78% say it is at least somewhat important for the U.S. and Europe to work together so tokenized investments can move freely across borders, including 20% who say it is extremely important.

These findings highlight that Americans are not only evaluating tokenized investments based on the benefits they might offer, but they also want confidence that the market will operate under clear, coordinated rules. Broad adoption will require a multipronged approach that makes tokenized investments feel safe, regulated, and legitimate.

Finding 4: Tokenization needs a clearer narrative to gain broader support

Consumers' own words show that tokenization does not yet have a clear mainstream narrative. A large share of respondents do not have a usable way to describe tokenized investments or explain why they matter. When asked what the potential benefits or drawbacks are, approximately two-thirds said "don't know" or otherwise non-substantive, while only a third responded with practical answers.

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Among the substantive responses, the positive comments clustered on a few themes:

- Easier access to investments
- Fractional ownership of expensive assets
- Faster buying, selling, and settlement
- 24/7 trading
- More liquidity
- Lower costs or fewer middlemen
- Transparency or easier tracking

However, the negative comments cluster around hacking, scams, lack of regulation, volatility, lack of backing, and confusion about whether tokenized assets are "real." This indicates that tokenized investments also have a challenge around building credibility.

Messaging around tokenization should translate the technology into familiar financial terms. Rather than leading with technical infrastructure, tokenized products should be explained a digital version of a familiar investment made easier to access, move, and own through trusted financial institutions.

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Messaging matrix for major financial institutions

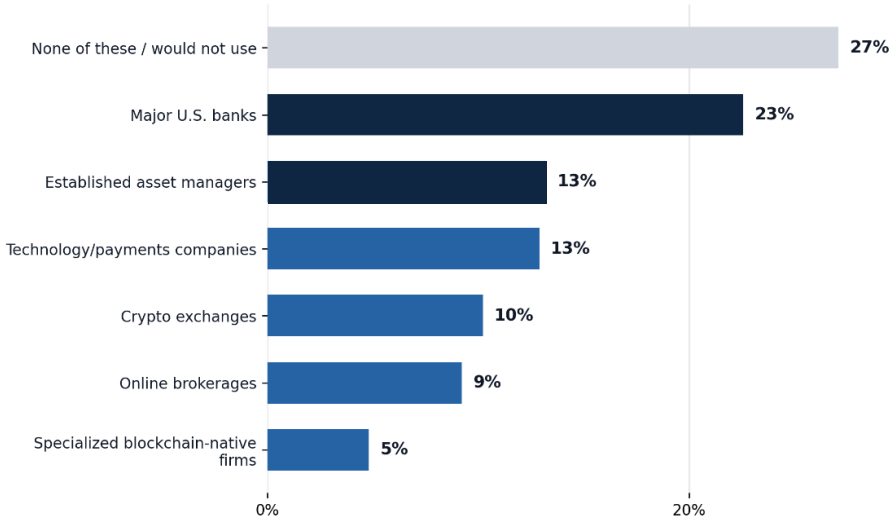
Lead with	Lower fees, 24/7 access, faster settlement, same protections, existing account compatibility
Reassure on	Cybersecurity, investor rights, clear rules, custody, fraud/scam protection
Avoid leading with	Blockchain, crypto-native infrastructure, programmability, disruption language
Position as	A safer, faster, lower-friction version of traditional investing

Synthesized from the results of questions:
TK5. You said you would be at least somewhat interested in tokenized investments. Which of the following features would matter MOST to you?
TK7. Which of the following, if any, would make you MORE likely to invest in tokenized funds or securities?
TK2. In your own words, what do you see as the potential benefits or drawbacks of tokenized investments, if any? If you don't know enough to say, please type "Don't know."

Finding 5: Major financial institutions are well-positioned to own this category

Major U.S. banks are the single most trusted provider type for tokenized investments at **23%**, ahead of asset managers, technology companies, crypto exchanges, brokerages, and blockchain-native firms.

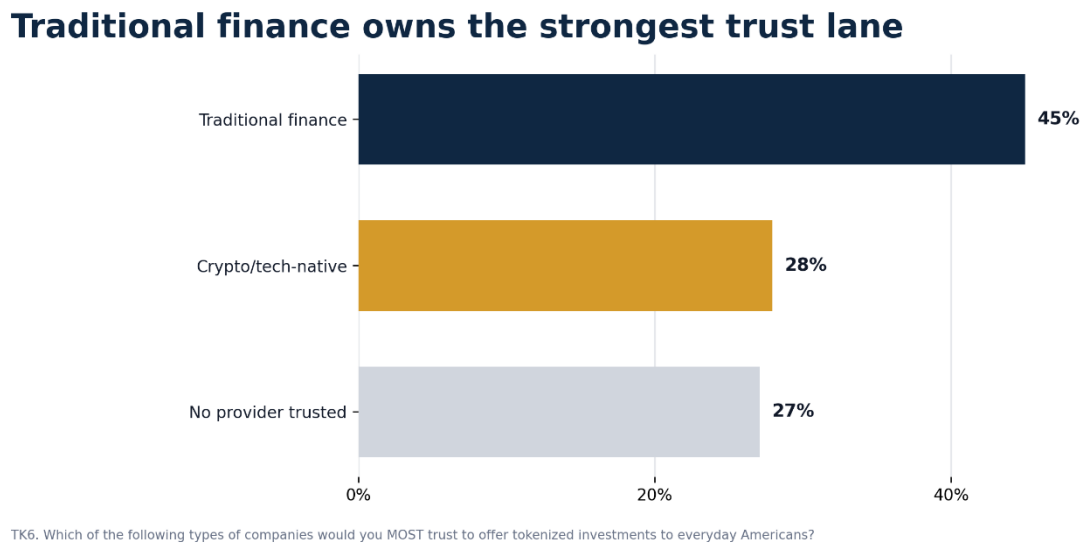
Major banks lead as the single most trusted provider



TK6. Which of the following types of companies would you MOST trust to offer tokenized investments to everyday Americans?

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When grouped at the category level, traditional finance institutions (e.g. banks, asset managers, and brokerages) collectively account for **45%** of provider trust, compared with **28%** for crypto/tech-native providers and **27%** who trust no provider.



TK6. Which of the following types of companies would you MOST trust to offer tokenized investments to everyday Americans?

This matters because tokenization could be defined in one of two ways. If crypto-native firms define it, consumers may see tokenized assets as another speculative digital-asset product. If banks, asset managers, and brokerages define it, consumers may see tokenization as a modernization of regulated financial products.

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Strategic Recommendations

1. **Tokenization is regulated financial modernization, not crypto innovation.** The mainstream frame should not be around blockchain, or crypto. Tokenization should be described as a digital version of familiar investments that can be accessed more flexibly, efficiently, and securely through trusted institutions.

2. **Prioritize early adopters.** Early momentum is likely to come from those already familiar with digital assets, younger and middle-aged adults, and investment-active consumers. These audiences are better positioned to understand the proposition quickly, while broader adoption will require more education, clearer protections, and trusted financial institutions as the entry point.

3. **Lead with practical benefits consumers already understand.** The strongest consumer-facing messages should be grounded in utility (faster settlement, 24/7 access, easier movement between platforms).

4. **Make tokenized investments feel safe, familiar, and clear.** People will not consider tokenized investments unless they understand what they are buying and what protections come with it.

5. **Treat education as part of the product, not just marketing.** The open-ended responses show that many Americans do not yet have the vocabulary to evaluate tokenization. Education should be embedded into product design, onboarding, disclosures, and marketing.

6. **Use trusted financial institutions as the front door.** Technology partners may power the infrastructure but should consider partnerships with the trusted institutional brand, including banks and asset managers, to win consumers over.

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How These Findings Support CTM's Policy Priorities

This report is a public opinion study; its findings are presented on their own terms. For members of the Coalition for Tokenized Markets (CTM), the results also reinforce the case for the coalition's core policy priorities.

CTM Priority	What the findings show
Expanding the permissioned wallet ecosystem	Consumers want tokenized assets to feel secure, protected, and accessible through accounts they already use. Traditional finance (45%) leads crypto- and tech-native providers (28%) on trust to offer tokenized investments.
Advancing technology-neutral regulation of tokenized securities and funds	Consumers respond most to lower costs, faster settlement, 24/7 access, and easier transfers. "Blockchain" is the weakest message, while clear SEC/CFTC rules help build confidence.
Promoting interoperability, international standards, and regulatory consistency	78% say U.S.–Europe coordination is important once told that separate rules could restrict the movement of tokenized funds. Easier transfer between platforms is also a top-valued benefit.
Promoting tokenized funds as eligible collateral	This use case was not directly tested. The report does show greater receptivity when tokenized products are regulated, backed by trusted institutions, and associated with faster settlement and easier transfer.

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About the Coalition for Tokenized Markets (CTM)

The Coalition for Tokenized Markets (CTM) is a U.S. and transatlantic industry coalition of asset managers, financial institutions, and technology and infrastructure providers working to advance the responsible development of tokenized securities and funds. CTM engages with policymakers and regulators across the United States and Europe to promote technology-neutral regulation of tokenized products, interoperability and common international standards, an expanded and trusted permissioned-wallet ecosystem, and the recognition of tokenized funds as eligible collateral.

CTM's founding members include WisdomTree, Janus Henderson, Franklin Templeton, and J.P. Morgan Asset Management.

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About HarrisX

HarrisX is a leading data-analytics and market-research firm that conducts multi-method research across the technology, media, telecommunications, financial-services, and consumer sectors. Part of the global Stagwell network, HarrisX operates in more than 40 countries and its data is regularly cited by major newsrooms, including The New York Times, Reuters, Forbes, Axios, and The Hill. Its polling has been recognized among the most accurate in recent U.S. election cycles, and the firm brings 25 years of experience delivering research that informs business strategy, product design, and public policy.

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